

Saturday, 3 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

21° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

17° 13°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Overcast

14° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Files have been sent to prosecutors regarding charges against the Kensington and Chelsea Tenants Management Organisation over the Grenfell Tower fire.

This is a significant development in the ongoing investigation into the 2017 tragedy. The organisation was responsible for managing the tower block.

DISASTER · UK

2 A man has been jailed for 15 years after an explosion at a Ulez camera, with the judge citing a 'terrorism connection' to the offence.

Kevin Rees, 63, received a tougher sentence due to the nature of the crime. This follows a growing number of attacks on Ulez cameras in recent months.

CRIME · UK

3 A major public safety operation is underway in Drumcree, Northern Ireland, as the Secretary of State appeals for calm amid ongoing tensions.

Police are continuing to investigate anyone suspected of breaking the law in relation to the dispute. The area has a history of unrest.

CIVIL UNREST · UK

4 The First Minister of Wales is demanding a 'new deal' from the UK government, seeking equal devolution of powers with Scotland.

Rhun ap Iorwerth wants policing, justice, and welfare powers devolved to Cardiff Bay. This comes amid ongoing debates about the future of the Union.

POLITICS · UK

5 New rules are being introduced in Scottish supermarkets, restricting the placement of products high in sugar, fat, and salt.

The aim is to encourage healthier eating habits, although the popular meal deal will remain. Shoppers might notice some changes to aisle layouts.

HEALTH · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Good news for festival fans, as the first Glastonbury 2027 tickets have already sold out!**
Coach tickets for the iconic festival were snapped up in less than 30 minutes. It seems demand is as high as ever for Worthy Farm.
ON AIR – Did you manage to get tickets for Glastonbury 2027, or are you hoping for the next release?
MUSIC · FUTURE
- 2 The new series of Celebrity Traitors has kicked off with plenty of chaos and dramatic twists!**
Viewers are already gripped by the paranoia and battles for survival among the famous faces. It looks set to be another wild ride.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of The Traitors? Who do you think is playing the best game so far?
TV · NOW
- 3 Veteran actor Bill Nighy has won Best Host at the British Podcast Awards for his agony uncle series.**
Organisers praised his 'irresistibly endearing' approach to giving advice. It's a new role for the much-loved star.
ON AIR – Would you take advice from Bill Nighy? What celebrity would make a great agony uncle or aunt?
AWARDS · NOW
- 4 Singer Lola Young has shared her concerns about vaping, saying it's made breathing feel like a 'chore'.**
The 'Messy' singer described her lungs as feeling 'battery powered'. It's a stark warning about the potential health effects.
ON AIR – Have you or anyone you know experienced health issues related to vaping? Is enough being done to highlight the risks?
HEALTH · NOW
- 5 K-pop giants Stray Kids have joined BTS in boycotting the Grammys over a new 'Best Asian Pop' award.**
They are the second major act to withdraw, suggesting they feel the new category is not inclusive enough. It's sparking a big debate in the music industry.
ON AIR – Do you think the Grammys are doing enough to recognise global music, or are they still behind the curve?
MUSIC · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City's guilty verdict over Premier League rule breaches could significantly impact their squad and future transfers.**

BBC Sport is looking at the potential consequences for existing players and the club's activity in the transfer market. It's a huge story for the Premier League.

ON AIR – If Man City face serious sanctions, do you think their top players will stay, or could we see a big exodus?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Wales came from behind to beat 10-man Norway 2-1 in the Nations League, securing a crucial victory.**

It was an exciting match with Wales showing great resilience to turn the game around. Fans will be hoping this is a turning point for the team.

ON AIR – After that comeback win, do you think this Welsh team has what it takes to push for qualification in the Nations League?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Christian Wade is closing in on Chris Ashton's all-time Premiership Rugby try-scoring record.**

Wade is just four tries away from Ashton's impressive tally of 101. It's been a try-filled season in the Premiership so far.

ON AIR – Who do you think is the greatest try-scorer in Premiership Rugby history, and why?
RUGBY · UK

4 **Manchester City's women's team held Real Madrid to an entertaining 1-1 draw in the Champions League.**

Khadija Shaw scored a superb equaliser before Real Madrid had a late goal disallowed. It was a spirited performance from City.

ON AIR – How important are these European results for raising the profile of women's football in the UK?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **The Portuguese computer hacker who exposed Manchester City's alleged financial breaches is set to lose his witness protection.**

This is despite fears for his life after releasing documents that led to the Premier League investigation. It's a controversial development in the ongoing case.

ON AIR – Do you think whistleblowers should always be granted lifelong protection, especially in high-profile cases like this?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A surprising new trend is seeing people embracing 'slow travel' closer to home.**
Instead of rushing to far-flung destinations, more individuals are choosing leisurely train journeys or canal boat trips within the UK, savouring the scenery and local stops along the way.
- 2 The humble art of 'darning socks' is experiencing a charming revival.**
This traditional mending skill, once a necessity, is now being embraced as a mindful, sustainable hobby, with workshops popping up in community centres across the country.
- 3 Experts are suggesting that 'the sound of distant church bells' can have a surprisingly calming effect.**
Research indicates that these gentle, rhythmic chimes can help reduce stress and foster a sense of peace, connecting us to a timeless, slower pace of life.
- 4 A delightful new study reveals the mood-boosting power of 'seeing a well-organised spice rack'.**
Psychologists suggest that the visual order and vibrant colours of a tidy spice collection can provide a small but significant hit of satisfaction and calm in our daily lives.
- 5 The simple pleasure of 'writing a letter to your future self' is gaining traction.**
People are setting aside moments to pen thoughts, dreams, and advice to be opened years down the line, offering a unique form of personal reflection and anticipation.
- 6 Gardening enthusiasts are discovering the unique joy of 'cultivating miniature vegetables'.**
Growing tiny carrots, micro-tomatoes, and compact cabbages offers a charming and space-efficient way to enjoy fresh produce, even on a small balcony.
- 7 Research highlights the surprising satisfaction derived from 'successfully untangling a knot'.**
Whether it's a shoelace, a piece of string, or headphones, the methodical process and ultimate triumph of unravelling a stubborn knot can be remarkably rewarding.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 75% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new book, especially if it's a highly anticipated one. What is it?

ANSWER: ADJUSTING THE LIGHTING JUST SO, ENSURING A COMFY BLANKET IS WITHIN REACH, AND MAKING A PERFECT CUP OF TEA OR COFFEE.

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GENTLY TILTING THE JAR TO SEE HOW SLOWLY IT MOVES, BELIEVING A THICKER, SLOWER JAM MEANS BETTER QUALITY.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of street market' just instantly makes you feel cheerful, perhaps because of its lively atmosphere or the unique items it sells?

Which kind of market stall or bustling high street moment always brightens your day, and why?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household chore' that, no matter how much we might grumble about it, secretly makes you feel oddly satisfied once it's done, don't we?

What's that one little job around the house that, despite yourself, always gives you a quiet sense of accomplishment when it's finished?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of pandas is called a 'cuddle'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The world's largest hot air balloon festival takes place annually in Albuquerque, New Mexico.
- The 'king of fruits', the durian, is famed for its distinctive aroma, which some describe as a mix of cheese, onion, and gym socks.
- A typical cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- The Great Barrier Reef is so large it can be seen from space.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The first orange carrots were bred in the Netherlands in the 17th century to honour the House of Orange.
- Penguins are the only birds that can't fly but can swim.

On this day

Day 276 of the year, 89 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Adalgott; Christian feast day: Ambrósio Francisco Ferro; Christian feast day: Blessed Szilárd Bogdánffy. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Paul Crichton, English footballer and manager
- 1981 — Matt Sparrow, English footballer
- 1973 — Lena Headey, British actress
- 1979 — Josh Klinghoffer, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1984 — Chris Marquette, American actor
- 1970 — Jimmy Ray, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1988 — ASAP Rocky, American rapper and songwriter
- 1981 — Danny Coid, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1949 — WERD, the first black-owned radio station in the United States, opens in Atlanta.
- 1962 — Project Mercury: US astronaut Wally Schirra, in Sigma 7, is launched from Cape Canaveral for a six-orbit flight.
- 2008 — The Emergency Economic Stabilization Act of 2008 for the U.S. financial system is signed by President George W. Bush.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1942 — A German V-2 rocket reaches a record 85 km (46 nm) in altitude.
- 1989 — A coup in Panama City is suppressed and 11 participants are executed.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1943 — World War II: German forces murder 92 civilians in Lingiades, Greece.
- 1986 — TASCC, a superconducting cyclotron at the Chalk River Laboratories in Canada, is officially opened.

- 1963 — A violent coup in Honduras begins two decades of military rule.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 277 of the year, 88 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Amun; Christian feast day: Aurea of Paris; Christian feast day: Francis of Assisi Conclusion of Creationtide; Christian feast day: Blessed Francis Xavier Seelos. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Rachael Leigh Cook, American actress
- 1973 — M. Ward, American singer-songwriter
- 1942 — Christopher Stone, American actor and screenwriter (died 1995)
- 1952 — Jody Stephens, American rock drummer
- 1961 — Jon Secada, Cuban-American singer-songwriter
- 1942 — Bernice Johnson Reagon, American singer-songwriter (died 2024)
- 1959 — Chris Lowe, English singer and keyboard player
- 1949 — Armand Assante, American actor and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Hurricane Flora kills 6,000 in Cuba and Haiti.
- 1983 — Richard Noble sets a new land speed record of 633.468 miles per hour (1,019.468 km/h) at the Black Rock Desert in Nevada.
- 1958 — The current constitution of France is adopted.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1993 — Tanks bombard the Russian parliament, while demonstrators against President Yeltsin rally outside.
- 1963 — Hurricane Flora kills 6,000 in Cuba and Haiti.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar